

Yiran Zhang

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Education

PhD student, University of California, Berkeley

2026.08 – Present

Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences (EECS)

Advisors: Jason D. Lee and Song Mei

BS, Tsinghua University

2022 – 2026

Computer Science and Technology, Institute for Interdisciplinary Information

GPA: 3.9/4.0

Publications

(* Equal contribution. † Authors listed alphabetically.)

- [1] **Yiran Zhang**, Mo Zhou, Weihang Xu, Maryam Fazel, Simon S. Du. *Is $\sqrt{d}$ Separation Necessary for Gradient EM to Learn Gaussian Mixtures in High Dimensions?* In *NeurIPS 2026*.
- [2] Haodong Wen*, **Yiran Zhang***, Yingfa Chen*, Kaifeng Lyu. *Frontier Language Models Struggle to Copy: Text Can Be Better Viewed in 2D*. In *NeurIPS 2026*.
- [3] † Kuowen Chen, Nicole Wein, **Yiran Zhang**. *A Polynomial-Time Algorithm for the Next-to-Shortest Path Problem on Positively Weighted Directed Graphs*. In *FOCS 2026*.
- [4] **Yiran Zhang**, Weihang Xu, Mo Zhou, Maryam Fazel, Simon Shaolei Du. *Convergence Dynamics of Over-Parameterized Score Matching for a Single Gaussian*. In *ICLR 2026*.
- [5] † Jian Li, Yinchun Liu, **Yiran Zhang**. *Adaptivity Gaps for Stochastic Probing with Subadditive Functions*. In *FOCS 2025*.
- [6] † Kuowen Chen, Jian Li, Yuval Rabani, **Yiran Zhang**. *New Results on a General Class of Minimum Norm Optimization Problems*. In *ICALP 2025*.

Skills

Technical: Python, C/C++, LaTeX, Matlab.

Mathematical: Probability, Measure Theory, Statistics, Linear Algebra, Abstract Algebra, Numerical Analysis.

Awards and Honors

International Mathematical Olympiad: Gold Medal (perfect score)	2022
Yau Mathematical Competition for Undergraduates: Team Merit Award	2024
Academic Excellence Scholarship , Tsinghua University	2024
Yao Award , Tsinghua University: Bronze Medal (top 9 in Yao Class)	2025
Outstanding Innovation Scholarship , Tsinghua University	2025